

Q Speaking of all of these design choices and the evolution of the ThinkPad over time, how much of this has actually translated to Lenovo's other lineup of laptops? Like what have they borrowed or in essence, learned from ThinkPad and utilised in their own designs?

A I think two aspects come to mind, top of mind. Number one, our world famous keyboard. And you'll see that keyboard quality shows up in all our product lineups. The second part is our quality and reliability that goes with it. So that also is permeated through a number of our products.

Q Would you also speak a little bit about how ThinkPad is being reintroduced to new generations year after year?

A That's where a lot of ThinkPad's value comes from. Make it more appealing to new users who are coming into the ThinkPad fold. At the core of what the ThinkPad is, it's such a huge focus on the users themselves. So we're constantly talking to Gen Zs, the millennials. What is it that matters to them? What is different? A lot of those insights actually led us to the ThinkPad Z series, right? A lot of it came from insights about the focus on sustainability, the focus on, you know, making sure, even driving a lot of innovation in the form factor.

Q In terms of thinking about the new paradigms, could you give us a little insight into what are some of the big ticket items on your plate and challenges that you are trying to solve in the next year?

A Yeah, absolutely. When we do our big data analytics, we know what the number one pain point is, right? It used to be displays, but now it's lately drivers, you know, firmware, BIOS updates. How do we simplify that? And that's an issue across the industry. We have to make sure that we have a good software experience overall. The second thing is our device collaboration, right? In this world where our customers have,

you know, Google devices, Microsoft devices, Apple devices, how does it all come together, right? How do we provide a seamless, personalised experience for our users? The third one is around sustainability. How do we map our entire journey for our products? So you've got this classic ThinkPad, how do we make it reusable? How do we make it easy to repair? So those are just top-of-mind three areas that I talked about in terms of what we're doing.

Q At what point in your internal sentiment analysis do you guys realise a new feature is a fad and it's not gonna work? And how do you take a leap of faith with something like a foldable screen?

A Because for the core audience, the type of audience that ThinkPad is supposed to be marketed towards is sup-



posed to be a no-nonsense, people who don't believe in fads who, you know, try to maximise their ROI as much as possible. So I guess as a company, you guys are in a very interesting space where you have to experiment, but you also have to draw the line very, very quickly in case some experiments are crossing into the fad sort of territory.

Q How do you guys internalise some of these big decisions?

A The beauty about working at Lenovo is you have the freedom to innovate. There's a sense of entrepreneurship within teams and you have teams that have the autonomy to make the decisions and bring new products to market. And they work very well with the geography teams or the sales teams on how we drive decisions. And there's always a balance at the end of the day. They're your core products like your T-Series or X-Series or your yoga line

that you don't mess around with. That's your bread and butter. But at any given time, there's a tremendous amount of excitement within Lenovo with all the innovation opportunities that we have across, because we're working with a number of suppliers. I'll tell you, even though the first X1 Fold was launched in 2020, the concept really started in 2015 with the User Experience Organization. That concept started with the User Experience Organization and I have two different UX teams. There's a UX team that kind of looks at, how do we make sure we have the best displays, the best cameras, the best keyboards? But then we also have another team which we call the Next UX Organization. And their job is to look two, three years out, four years out on what are the coming trends in technology. And the Foldable actually started with that team in 2015, 2016,

is it a dual display? Is it a single fold? Is the technology mature and ready to go? So there are always teams. Even in fact, even when I ran the ThinkPad VU, we had a bread and butter

T-Series and X-Series, but I always felt we needed a product like an X1 Carbon, and it was easy for me to go justify, have that discussion with our leadership teams, invest behind it. And is every product launch a home run? Absolutely not, and that's okay. That's the culture of Lenovo that allows you to fail. Learn from it. What worked well? What didn't work well? And if you have to fail, let's fail fast. Let's learn from it and move on to the next project. So it's always that balance. You always want to have some kind of leading edge; technology that basically creates a halo effect for the rest of the portfolio.

Q I think we've got a pretty good idea of how Lenovo comes up with new stuff and hopefully they're already working on what Lenovo's gonna come out with five years later!

A You better believe it. **[i]**